Worksheet B: Searching and Documenting

Name: _____ Date: _____

Task 2: Collecting search terms

in class, individual work, 10 min.

Break your research question from Unit 2 down into two or three concepts. For each, collect terms in English and in a second language, synonyms, broader and narrower terms. Mark where truncation (`*`) is useful: `learn*` finds *learn*, *learning*, *learner*.

My research question:

	Concept 1	**Concept 2**	**Concept 3**
Term (English)			
Synonyms			
second language			
Broader/narrower terms			

Task 3: Search string and counter-search

in class, 5 min.

1. Build a search string from the table: synonyms with `OR`, concepts with `AND`.
2. Write a second search string that specifically finds work that could *contradict* your expected answer (terms such as `no effect`, `null result`, `failed replication`, `critique`, or the counter-hypothesis itself).

Search string 1:

Search string 2 (counter-search):

Task 4: Search log

start in class, homework, 10 % of the portfolio grade

Carry out a documented search in at least two databases. One row per search. Record search terms, databases, number of hits and selection criteria precisely enough for another person to repeat your search.

Date	Database	Search string	Filters	Hits	Screen-ed	Selected

Inclusion and exclusion criteria (e. g. language, time period, publication type, population):

Snowballing: Which two key texts did you follow backwards and forwards? What new material did this turn up?

Task 5: Sorting hits

in class, 10 min.

Assign your first five hits to a level. The levels are a working aid for the first screening, not a quality judgement in the individual case; that follows in Unit 4.

Level	Publication type
A	systematic review, meta-analysis, peer-reviewed journal article
B	academic book, handbook chapter, peer-reviewed conference paper
C	grey literature: preprint, thesis, report by a public agency or foundation
D	trade press, science journalism, textbook knowledge without references
E	blog, video, advertising, source without identifiable authorship

Task 6: Annotated bibliography

homework, due by Unit 4

Comment on five sources you have found, with two to three sentences each on *key message*, *method* and *relevance to your question*. At least one source should come from the counter-search. Manage the sources in a reference manager (Zotero, Citavi or JabRef).

Example of an annotation:

Nickerson, R. S. (1998). Confirmation bias: A ubiquitous phenomenon in many guises. *Review of General Psychology, 2*(2), 175–220. https://doi.org/10.1037/1089-2680.2.2.175

Key message: People preferentially seek, interpret and remember information that supports an existing belief; the effect appears in science, medicine, law, politics and everyday life. *Method:* review of experimental and historical findings, no data collection of its own. *Relevance:* Explains why my search must also look for contradicting findings.